

EE5203 L07 Lab Guide

Timer interrupts — a 1 ms tick instead of HAL_Delay() - Basri Erdogan

Mission: Build a 1 ms tick from a TIM2 update interrupt, drive a heartbeat blink from it with no HAL_Delay() anywhere, and prove in the SFR view that the hardware counts while your loop stays free.

Prepare before class

- ☐ Re-read the theory slides up to “The 1 ms tick.”
- ☐ Compute from 16 MHz: which PSC/ARR give a 1 ms update event?
- ☐ Know which register bit records the update event and who clears it.

Learning objectives

By checkoff time, you can:

1. configure a TIM2 time base in CubeMX from the real 16 MHz clock;
2. run an update-interrupt callback and keep it short;
3. schedule LED phases from a millisecond counter, wrap-safe;
4. drive a bare-metal microsecond timer and explain every register write.

Hardware and files

Item	Required value
Board	Nucleo-F401RE — onboard LD2 (PA5) only, no wiring
Clock	Default HSI: SYSCLK = PCLK1 = timer clock = 16 MHz
Project	New CubeMX project L07_Timer_Tick (Toolchain = CMake), opened in VS Code
Timer	TIM2, internal clock source

Configure in CubeMX

1. PA5 → GPIO_Output (defaults: push-pull, no pull, low speed).
2. **Timers** → **TIM2**: Clock Source = **Internal Clock**; Prescaler 15 (16 MHz ÷ 16 = 1 MHz), Counter Period 999 (1 MHz ÷ 1000 → 1 ms).
3. **System Core** → **NVIC**: enable **TIM2 global interrupt**.
4. Generate code, then **verify** — **do not add**: MX_TIM2_Init() in main.c and TIM2_IRQHandler() calling HAL_TIM_IRQHandler(&htim2) in stm32f4xx_it.c.

Checkpoint A - The tick runs

In USER CODE BEGIN PV and USER CODE BEGIN 4:

```
volatile uint32_t g_ms = 0;

void HAL_TIM_PeriodElapsedCallback(TIM_HandleTypeDef *htim)
{
    if (htim->Instance == TIM2) {
        g_ms++;
    }
}
```

In USER CODE BEGIN 2: HAL_TIM_Base_Start_IT(&htim2);

Evidence for Checkpoint A: a breakpoint in the callback is hit; g_ms grows between pauses; in the SFR view TIM2->PSC = 15, TIM2->ARR = 999, and TIM2->CNT is moving.

Checkpoint B - Heartbeat without delay

Blink a heartbeat — LD2 on for 100 ms, off for 900 ms — using only g_ms:

```
uint32_t t_phase = 0;
uint8_t led_on = 0;

while (1) {
    uint32_t wait = led_on ? 100U : 900U;

    if ((g_ms - t_phase) >= wait) {
        t_phase = g_ms;
        led_on = !led_on;
    }
}
```

```

        HAL_GPIO_WritePin(GPIOA, GPIO_PIN_5,
                           led_on ? GPIO_PIN_SET : GPIO_PIN_RESET);
    }
    /* the loop stays free for other work */
}

```

The unsigned subtraction stays correct when `g_ms` wraps — Week 6’s debounce arithmetic again.

Evidence for Checkpoint B: the 100/900 pattern is visible and `main.c` contains no `HAL_Delay()` call.

Checkpoint C - Bare-metal microsecond timer

In a separate source file or `#ifdef` block, rebuild the blink at 250 ms on/off with **no HAL timer calls**:

```

RCC->APB1ENR |= (1U << 0); // TIM2 clock (APB1, not AHB1!)
TIM2->PSC = 15; // 16 MHz / 16 = 1 MHz: 1 tick = 1 us
TIM2->ARR = 0xFFFFFFFU; // free-run: TIM2 is 32-bit
TIM2->EGR = (1U << 0); // force update: load PSC now
TIM2->CR1 |= (1U << 0); // CEN: start counting

static inline void delay_us(uint32_t us)
{
    uint32_t start = TIM2->CNT;
    while ((TIM2->CNT - start) < us) { }
}

```

Evidence for Checkpoint C: the blink runs; you can explain the `EGR` write and why the subtraction survives counter wrap (~71 minutes at 1 MHz).

Individual extension - Button-selected speed

Using the Checkpoint B loop: B1 (PC13, input, **no pull** — the external resistor is on the board) cycles the blink period through 500 → 200 → 50 ms. Debounce with 50 ms of `g_ms`, exactly as in Week 6. Optional: add `__WFI()`; at the loop end and confirm timing still holds.

Acceptance checklist

- ☐ .ioc: TIM2 PSC 15 / ARR 999, NVIC enabled; PA5 output.
- ☐ Callback checks `htim->Instance` and only increments a counter.
- ☐ SFR evidence: PSC, ARR, moving CNT shown for Checkpoint A.
- ☐ No `HAL_Delay()` anywhere in the HAL tasks.
- ☐ Bare-metal version explained register by register.
- ☐ Extension demonstrated with clean speed switching.

Individual oral check

- Why 15 and 999 — and what breaks without the two +1s?
- What would happen if the callback did the LED writes and took 2 ms?
- Why is `g_ms` declared `volatile`, and why is the subtraction wrap-safe?
- TIM2 is on which bus, and which register enables its clock?

Submit

Submit `main.c` (plus the bare-metal file), and one SFR-view screenshot showing `TIM2->PSC`, `TIM2->ARR`, and a nonzero `TIM2->CNT`.

If you are stuck

Walk the pipeline left to right and fix the **first** silent stage: PSC/ARR values in the SFR view → CNT moving → UIF setting in SR → NVIC enabled → breakpoint in the callback → `g_ms` growing → your loop condition. **CNT frozen?** Timer never started or clock not enabled. **Callback never runs?** NVIC checkbox or `Start_IT` missing. **Pattern timing drifts?** You reset `t_phase` to `g_ms` somewhere other than the phase change.